HTML Interview Questions

Short 2-3 Line Answers for Study and Exam Preparation

Total questions summarized: 95

Contents

Basic HTML Interview Questions

1. What are the different kinds of Doctypes available?

There are mainly three older HTML doctypes: Strict, Transitional, and Frameset. In modern HTML5, the standard doctype is <!DOCTYPE html>.

2. How to specify a link in HTML and explain the target attribute?

A link is created using the <a> tag with the href attribute. The target attribute decides where the link opens, such as _self, _blank, _parent, or _top.

3. What is the difference between display: none and visibility: hidden?

visibility: hidden hides the element but still keeps its space on the page. display: none hides the element completely and removes its space from the layout.

4. In how many ways can we display HTML elements?

Common display values are inline, block, inline-block, flex, grid, none, etc. These values control how elements appear and behave in the page layout.

5. In how many ways can we position an HTML element?

Main position values are static, relative, absolute, fixed, sticky, initial, and inherit. They control how an element is placed on the webpage.

6. Is it possible to change an inline element into a block-level element?

Yes, an inline element can be changed into a block-level element using CSS. Example: display: block;.

7. How can we club two or more rows or columns into a single row or column in an HTML table?

Rows can be merged using the rowspan attribute. Columns can be merged using the colspan attribute.

8. How is cell padding different from cell spacing?

Cell padding is the space between cell content and the cell border. Cell spacing is the gap between two table cells.

9. Can we display a web page inside another web page?

Yes, we can display one webpage inside another using the <iframe> tag. It embeds an external page within the current HTML page.

10. What is the significance of <head> and <body> tags in HTML?

The <head> contains metadata, title, CSS links, scripts, and other information not directly shown on the page. The <body> contains the visible content like text, images, videos, forms, and links.

11. What is the difference between <strong>, <b> tags and <em>, <i> tags?

<b> and <i> only make text bold or italic visually. <strong> and <em> give semantic importance, meaning the text is important or emphasized.

12. How to indicate the character set being used by a document in HTML?

The character set is defined using the <meta> tag inside the <head>. Example: <meta charset="UTF-8">.

13. In how many ways can we specify CSS styles for HTML elements?

CSS can be applied in three ways: inline CSS, internal CSS, and external CSS. Inline uses the style attribute, internal uses <style>, and external uses a linked CSS file.

14. What are the various formatting tags in HTML?

HTML formatting tags change the appearance or meaning of text. Examples include <b>, <i>, <em>, <strong>, <mark>, <sub>, <sup>, <del>, and <ins>.

15. How to optimize website assets loading?

Website assets can be optimized using CDN hosting, file compression, minification, lazy loading, and file concatenation. These reduce loading time and improve performance.

16. Describe HTML layout structure.

HTML layout uses semantic tags like <header>, <nav>, <section>, <article>, <aside>, and <footer>. These help organize webpage content clearly.

17. Define multipart form data.

multipart/form-data is an encoding type used in forms when uploading files. It sends form data and file data properly to the server.

18. What is the difference between the id attribute and the class attribute of HTML elements?

An id must be unique and used for one element only. A class can be used on multiple elements to apply common styling or behavior.

19. What is the class attribute in HTML?

The class attribute gives one or more class names to an HTML element. It is mainly used to apply CSS styles or select elements using JavaScript.

20. What are different types of lists in HTML?

HTML has ordered lists <ol>, unordered lists <ul>, and description lists <dl>. Ordered lists use numbers, unordered lists use bullets, and description lists define terms.

21. What are HTML Entities?

HTML entities are used to display reserved characters like <, >, &, and spaces. Example: < is written as <.

22. What is the advantage of collapsing white space?

HTML treats multiple spaces as a single space in the browser. This helps developers write readable and indented code without affecting page display.

23. What are void elements in HTML?

Void elements do not need closing tags. Examples include
, <img>, <hr>, <input>, and <meta>.

24. What are tags and attributes in HTML?

Tags define the structure and type of content, such as <p> or <img>. Attributes provide extra information, such as src, href, alt, or class.

25. Are HTML tags and elements the same thing?

No, a tag is only the opening or closing markup. An element includes the opening tag, content, and closing tag together.

26. How to handle events in HTML?

HTML events are actions like click, change, submit, or drag. They can be handled using JavaScript event attributes like onclick or by adding event listeners.

27. What are forms and how to create forms in HTML?

Forms collect user input using the <form> tag. Inputs like text, password, checkbox, radio, and submit are added using the <input> tag.

28. When to use scripts in the head and when to use scripts in the body?

Scripts needed early, like libraries, can be placed in the <head>. Scripts that affect page content are usually placed before the closing <body> tag for better performance.

29. How to include JavaScript code in HTML?

JavaScript is included using the <script> tag. It can be written inside the HTML file or linked externally using the src attribute.

30. Difference between link tag <link> and anchor tag <a>?

<a> creates clickable hyperlinks for users. <link> connects the HTML document to external resources like CSS files and is not clickable.

HTML5 Interview Questions

31. Explain HTML5 Graphics.

HTML5 supports graphics using Canvas and SVG. Canvas is pixel-based drawing, while SVG is vector-based and better for scalable icons and diagrams.

32. What is new about the relationship between the <header> and <h1> tags in HTML5?

The <header> tag represents the introductory part of a page or section. It can contain headings like <h1>, navigation, logos, or other introductory content.

33. Explain new input types provided by HTML5 for forms.

HTML5 introduced input types like date, time, email, number, color, range, url, search, and tel. These improve validation and user experience.

34. What are the new tags in Media Elements in HTML5?

HTML5 introduced media tags like <audio>, <video>, <source>, <track>, and <embed>. These allow audio and video without external plugins.

35. Why is drag-and-drop functionality in HTML5 important?

Drag and drop makes user interaction easier, especially for moving items or uploading files. It uses attributes like draggable and events like dragover and drop.

36. Why do we need the MathML element in HTML5?

MathML is used to display mathematical equations and expressions on webpages. It uses the <math> tag and related elements.

37. What are server-sent events in HTML5?

Server-sent events allow a server to send live updates to the browser over one long connection. They are useful for notifications, live scores, or real-time feeds.

38. What are Web Workers?

Web Workers run JavaScript in the background without blocking the webpage. They help perform heavy tasks while keeping the page responsive.

39. What is the usage of a novalidate attribute for the form tag?

The novalidate attribute stops the browser from validating form input before submission. It is useful when validation is handled manually or later.

40. What are raster images and vector images?

Raster images are made of pixels, such as JPG and PNG. Vector images are made of paths and shapes, such as SVG, and can scale without losing quality.

41. How to support SVG in old browsers?

Use SVG with a fallback image like PNG. The browser can load SVG if supported and fall back to PNG if not.

42. What are different approaches to make an image responsive?

Responsive images can be made using <picture>, srcset, sizes, SVG, and CSS like max-width: 100%. These help images fit different screen sizes.

43. What is a manifest file in HTML5?

A manifest file lists resources that can be cached for offline use. It can include cache files, network-only files, and fallback files.

44. What is the Geolocation API in HTML5?

The Geolocation API gets the user's physical location with permission. It is commonly used in maps, location-based services, and delivery apps.

45. Write HTML5 code to demonstrate the use of Geolocation API.

Geolocation works through navigator.geolocation.getCurrentPosition(). It returns location details like latitude and longitude after user permission.

46. Explain Web Components and its usage.

Web Components help create reusable custom HTML elements. They use Custom Elements, Shadow DOM, and HTML Templates.

47. Is the <datalist> tag and <select> tag same?

No, <select> forces users to choose from fixed options. <datalist> gives suggestions but also allows users to type their own value.

48. Which tag is used for representing the result of a calculation?

The <output> tag represents the result of a calculation. It can be connected with form inputs using attributes like for, form, and name.

49. What is Microdata in HTML5?

Microdata adds structured data to HTML using attributes like itemscope, itemtype, and itemprop. It helps search engines understand page content better.

50. Explain the concept of web storage in HTML5.

Web Storage stores data in the browser. localStorage keeps data permanently, while sessionStorage keeps data only for one browser session.

51. What are the significant goals of the HTML5 specification?

HTML5 aimed to improve semantics, multimedia support, cross-browser behavior, and plugin-free interactivity. It also maintained backward compatibility.

52. What type of audio files can be played using HTML5?

HTML5 commonly supports MP3, WAV, and Ogg audio formats. Browser support may vary slightly.

53. Difference between SVG and Canvas HTML5 element?

SVG is vector-based, scalable, and can be styled with CSS. Canvas is pixel-based, better for dynamic drawing, games, and animations.

54. Is drag and drop possible using HTML5 and how?

Yes, drag and drop is possible in HTML5 using drag events. Elements can be made draggable with the draggable="true" attribute.

55. What is the difference between <meter> tag and <progress> tag?

<progress> shows task completion, such as file upload progress. <meter> shows a value within a known range, such as rating or disk usage.

56. Convert data into tabular format in HTML5.

Use <table> for the table, <tr> for rows, <th> for headings, and <td> for data cells. This creates structured tabular data.

57. What are Semantic Elements?

Semantic elements clearly describe their meaning to browsers and developers. Examples include <form>, <table>, <article>, <section>, and <figure>.

58. Define Image Map.

An image map allows different parts of an image to be clickable. It uses the <map> and <area> tags with coordinates.

59. How to specify the metadata in HTML5?

Metadata is specified using the <meta> tag inside the <head>. Common attributes are charset, name, content, and http-equiv.

60. What is the difference between <figure> tag and <img> tag?

<img> is used to embed an image. <figure> groups self-contained content like images, diagrams, or code with captions.

61. Inline and block elements in HTML5?

Inline elements take only the required space and do not start on a new line. Block elements start on a new line and usually take full width.

62. How can we include audio or video in a webpage?

Use <audio> to add sound and <video> to add video. The <source> tag can provide different media formats.

63. What are some advantages of HTML5 over previous versions?

HTML5 supports multimedia, semantic tags, offline storage, canvas graphics, and background JavaScript. It reduces dependency on external plugins.

Advanced HTML Interview Questions

64. What are semantic HTML best practices, and why do they matter for accessibility and SEO?

Semantic HTML uses meaningful tags like <main>, <nav>, <article>, and <footer>. It improves screen reader navigation, code clarity, and search engine understanding.

65. When should you use a button vs an anchor <a>?

Use <a> for navigation to another page or section. Use <button> for actions like submitting forms, opening modals, or toggling content.

66. What is the purpose of ARIA, and when should you not use ARIA?

ARIA improves accessibility for custom UI components by adding roles, states, and labels. Do not use ARIA when native HTML elements already provide correct accessibility.

67. What is the difference between accessible name sources: aria-label, label, and aria-labelledby?

aria-label gives an invisible accessible name. <label> is best for form inputs, while aria-labelledby uses visible text from another element as the accessible name.

68. How do fieldset and legend improve form accessibility?

<fieldset> groups related form controls, and <legend> gives the group a shared label. This helps screen readers explain the full context of grouped inputs.

69. What is the difference between autocomplete, inputmode, and pattern?

autocomplete helps browsers fill saved data. inputmode changes mobile keyboard layout, while pattern validates input using a regular expression.

70. What is the form attribute on inputs/buttons and when is it useful?

The form attribute connects an input or button to a form even if it is outside the <form> tag. It is useful in complex layouts.

71. What is the difference between readonly and disabled inputs?

readonly fields cannot be edited but are focusable and submitted with the form. disabled fields cannot be focused, edited, or submitted.

72. What is the difference between <section>, <article>, and <div>?

<article> is for standalone content, like blog posts. <section> groups related content, while <div> has no semantic meaning and is mainly for layout.

73. What is the purpose of the <base> tag, and what common issues can it cause?

The <base> tag sets the default URL for relative links. It can cause routing or anchor-link problems if used incorrectly, especially in single-page apps.

74. How does loading="lazy" work for images/iframes?

loading="lazy" delays loading images or iframes until they are near the viewport. Avoid it for important above-the-fold images like hero banners.

75. What is Subresource Integrity (SRI)?

Subresource Integrity checks whether external scripts or styles have been changed. The browser compares the file with the given hash and blocks it if it does not match.

76. What do rel="noopener noreferrer" do for external links?

These attributes protect pages opened with target="_blank". noopener stops the new page from controlling the original page, and noreferrer hides referral information.

77. What is the purpose of the iframe sandbox attribute?

sandbox restricts what embedded iframe content can do. A safe approach is to start with full restrictions and allow only necessary permissions.

78. What is the difference between srcdoc and src in iframes?

src loads iframe content from an external URL. srcdoc writes HTML directly inside the iframe and is useful for small previews or sandboxed content.

79. What are preload, prefetch, and preconnect?

preload loads important current-page resources early. prefetch prepares future resources, while preconnect starts early connection to another domain.

80. What does the lang attribute affect, and where should it be set?

The lang attribute tells browsers and screen readers the language of the content. It affects pronunciation, translation, spelling, and hyphenation.

HTML, CSS, and JavaScript Interview Questions

81. How do HTML, CSS, and JavaScript work together in the browser rendering pipeline?

HTML builds the DOM, CSS builds the CSSOM, and both form the render tree. JavaScript can modify the DOM/CSSOM and may block rendering if not loaded carefully.

82. What is the DOM, and how is it different from the CSSOM?

The DOM represents the structure and content of the HTML page. The CSSOM represents the styling rules, and both are combined to render the webpage.

83. What is the difference between reflow/layout and repaint?

Reflow recalculates layout, size, and position, so it is expensive. Repaint only redraws visual changes like color or background and is usually cheaper.

84. Why is event delegation useful, and when should you use it?

Event delegation attaches one event listener to a parent instead of many child elements. It saves memory and works well for dynamically added elements.

85. What is the difference between event.target and event.currentTarget?

event.target is the actual element that triggered the event. event.currentTarget is the element where the event listener is attached.

86. How does CSS specificity work, and how can you avoid specificity wars?

CSS specificity decides which rule wins when multiple rules apply. Inline styles are strongest, then IDs, classes/attributes, and finally element selectors.

87. What is the difference between relative units em, rem, %, vh, and vw?

em depends on parent font size, while rem depends on root font size. % depends on parent size, and vh/vw depend on viewport height and width.

88. How do you make a layout responsive using Flexbox/Grid and media queries?

Use mobile-first CSS, then add media queries for larger screens. Flexbox is good for one-direction layouts, while Grid is better for two-dimensional layouts.

89. What is the difference between inline, block, and inline-block?

Inline elements stay in the text flow and cannot take width/height properly. Block elements take full width, while inline-block stays inline but allows width and height.

90. What are data-* attributes used for?

data-* attributes store custom information in HTML elements. JavaScript can read them using dataset, but they should not store sensitive data.

91. What is the difference between defer and async on script loading?

Both allow scripts to download without blocking HTML parsing. defer runs after HTML parsing in order, while async runs immediately after download and may be out of order.

92. How do you safely update the DOM without causing XSS?

Use textContent when inserting plain text because it does not execute HTML. Use innerHTML only when necessary and sanitize user content first.

93. How do you implement client-side form validation UX using HTML constraints and JS enhancements?

Use HTML attributes like required, type, minlength, maxlength, and pattern for basic validation. JavaScript should only improve messages and user experience.

94. What is Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS), and how can HTML/CSS choices reduce it?

CLS measures unexpected movement of webpage content during loading. It can be reduced by setting image sizes, reserving space for ads, and avoiding layout-changing animations.

95. What is the best way to handle responsive images and performance?

Use srcset, sizes, and <picture> to serve suitable images for each device. Use CSS for fluid sizing and lazy loading for offscreen images.